

JERMAL SMITH

Director, IT & Security | Infrastructure, Risk & Digital Transformation Leader

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Technology and security executive with 20 years building and scaling IT and security functions for regulated organizations, including 11 years in progressive leadership roles. Led a four-year, multi-phase M&A integration as primary integration lead, sustaining zero unplanned outages and zero major audit findings, a track record that directly unblocked RFPs, new deals, and contract renewals with enterprise customers. Manages multi-million-dollar budgets and blended, geo-dispersed teams, partnering across engineering, security, and business functions. A hands-on leader who stays technically current, applying the same compliance and risk discipline to independently engineered AI tools (see Applied AI Engineering & Independent Projects).

- Zero unplanned outages across 4-year, multi-phase Honeywell M&A integration
- \$4M+ annual IT budget managed; **\$4-8M R&D procurement portfolio** optimized
- Zero major findings across consecutive **SOC 2, ISO 27001, and ISO 9001** audits

CORE COMPETENCIES

IT & Security Strategy | Digital Transformation | M&A Integration & Due Diligence | Enterprise Risk Management

Business Continuity & Disaster Recovery | Global Team Leadership & Development | Budget, Procurement & Vendor Governance | Incident Response Leadership

Cloud Infrastructure (Azure, AWS, M365) | Zero Trust Architecture & IAM | Regulatory Compliance (SOC 2, ISO 27001/9001, HIPAA, GDPR, FedRAMP, NIST, CIS) | AI Enablement & Automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

HONEYWELL | Hamilton, NJ

2015 – 2026

Formerly Sparta Systems, Inc., a regulated Life Sciences SaaS company acquired by Honeywell in 2020. Progressed from Expert Systems Administrator through Senior Manager/Director over an 11-year tenure, building and scaling the IT/Security function and later serving as primary IT integration lead and cross-functional liaison to QE, R&D, Security, Compliance, Legal, Procurement, and Finance throughout the four-year M&A.

Senior Manager/Director, Information Technology

2021 – 2026

- Expanded and led IT operations, cybersecurity, compliance, engineering operations, and business applications, directing a blended team of up to 15, dotted-line, and matrix staff across the US, UK, and India.
- Directed multi-year IT strategy and shared roadmaps driving digital transformation across infrastructure, cloud, and security investment, aligned to growth targets and regulatory requirements across a 400+ person global organization.
- Directed primary IT integration and service ownership for all Sparta applications within Honeywell's CMDB across network trust establishment, end-user computing migration, and full data center workload transition; completed Q2 2025 with zero unplanned service outages.
- Sustained zero major findings across consecutive SOC 2, ISO 27001, and ISO 9001 audits, remediating 50+ control requirements while maintaining continuous audit readiness through a concurrent M&A integration. Directly supported Sales and Pre-Sales in RFP processes, unblocking new deals and contract renewals across 40+ top-tier pharmaceutical and medical device customers.
- Optimized a \$12M+ combined IT budget and procurement portfolio, cutting operational overhead by up to 35% through strategic vendor consolidation to directly fund cloud and security transformation.
- Spearheaded a global Zero Trust rollout across 100% of users and directed NIST/CIS-aligned enterprise risk management to focus executive oversight on top-tier risks.
- Restructured and expanded the team to 15 members, assuming governance for Engineering Operations, business systems, and software escrow throughout enterprise integration into Honeywell.
- Directed enterprise-wide platform modernizations, leading cloud migration from VMware to Azure, Kubernetes adoption, Microsoft 365 consolidation, and dev tool standardization on GitHub.
- Directed incident command and global follow-the-sun escalation models for customer-facing services, leading root-cause resolution, transparent stakeholder communications, and crisis alignment across all third-party technical vendors.

IT Manager

2018 – 2020

- Built and scaled the IT/Security function from the ground up, leading a 7-person blended team delivering IT service, vendor strategy, and technology planning across the US, UK, and India.
- Executed enterprise business continuity response, mobilizing full remote-work capability for 300-400 employees and contractors across three countries in under four weeks, expanding VPN capacity and deploying SD-WAN for lasting network resilience.
- Architected and deployed enterprise Intune, Autopilot, and VDI across all regions, establishing automated device provisioning and Azure AD compliance.
- Consolidated communications onto Microsoft Teams, eliminating 500 redundant Slack licenses (approximately \$40K annual savings) while closing an SSO compliance gap.
- Formalized IT procurement and vendor evaluation processes, establishing business case frameworks that aligned software selection with SOC 2 compliance and executive risk oversight.
- Established SLA frameworks, performance KPIs, and career development plans that increased delivery consistency and retention while directing multi-million-dollar operational budgets and build-vs-buy strategies.

Expert Systems Administrator

2015 – 2018

- Architected enterprise VMware/Hyper-V virtualization, SAN/NAS storage, and global networking infrastructure (Check Point, Cisco, Aruba), implementing PowerShell and Ansible automation and leading data center consolidation to improve RTO/RPO targets.
- Authored foundational IT policies, standard operating procedures (SOPs), and infrastructure deployment blueprints, establishing the operational controls, change management framework, and groundwork for initial SOC 2 readiness.

EARLIER CAREER

Infragistics, NJ | IT Senior Systems Administrator/Team Lead | 2007–2015

HANDS-ON AI ENGINEERING & INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

Architect and deploy modern AI tools, custom GRC software, and operational automation, applying enterprise risk and governance discipline to self-directed engineering. Active projects include an agentic AI recruiting platform (HyrLink), a custom Third-Party Risk Management (TPRM) tool, and a lightweight IT Risk Register for emerging GRC teams. Full portfolio available at: <https://whois.iernsmit.com>

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & Identity: Azure, AWS, Microsoft 365, Entra ID (Azure AD), Zero Trust, RBAC/CBAC, SSO/SAML, MFA, PAM

Infrastructure & DR: VMware vSphere, Hyper-V, Data Center Operations, SD-WAN, VPN, Endpoint Protection, Veeam (RTO/RPO)

AI & Automation: Copilot, Claude, Agentic AI, Terraform, Ansible, PowerShell, Python, PostgreSQL, MySQL/MariaDB

Frameworks & Compliance: SOC 2, ISO 27001/9001, NIST CSF, CIS Controls, HIPAA, GDPR, FedRAMP, ITIL

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

Certifications: VMware Certified Professional (VCP6-DCV) | VMware vExpert | Microsoft Certified (MCSE) | CompTIA Security+

Education: Bachelor of Arts (B.A.), Sociology – Monmouth University | Computer Systems & Networking Program – New Horizons